

## Apache Software Foundation announces Apache PLC4X as a Top-Level Project

The Apache Software Foundation (ASF), the all-volunteer developer and incubator of over 350 open source projects and initiatives, has announced that Apache PLC4X is now a Top-Level Project (TLP). This is also the 200th project to come out from the Apache Incubator.

Apache PLC4X is a universal protocol adapter for developing Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) applications via a set of libraries that enable unified access to a vast range of industrial programmable logic controllers (PLCs), by utilising a number of protocols with a shared application programming interface (API). Originally, the project was created at codecentric AG. In December 2017, it came under the Apache Incubator.

Commenting on the development, Christofer Dutz, vice president, Apache PLC4X, said, "There is a lot of hype about Industry 4.0, IIoT, and digitisation; however, there's unfortunately been no viable way to access industrial PLCs from the open source world. Apache PLC4X is the missing link between open source and the reality on today's industrial shop floor."

"We are proud that PLC4X is helping redefine how industrial software is created, and graduating to an Apache Top-Level Project is an important milestone in solidifying our project's maturity," Dutz added.

It is often impossible to have integration and connectivity across industrial hardware and IoT edge gateways, with closed-source, incompatible protocols, proprietary legacy systems and locked-in vendor solutions. Apache PLC4X is not only an API to communicate with industrial hardware, it also offers a set of drivers for communicating by leveraging a range of industrial protocols. Besides, PLC4X ships with a vast variety of integration modules that make it simple to use in other open source frameworks and solutions.

The organisations that need unified access to any kind of industrial PLCs can choose Apache PLC4X in order to capture actionable intelligence by way of an increasing number of interconnected systems and sensors.

## F5 Networks completes US\$ 670 million NGINX acquisition

F5 Networks, a global company that specialises in application services and application delivery networking (ADN), has announced that it has completed the acquisition of NGINX. The deal was closed at US\$ 670 million.

NGINX specialises in open source software-based application delivery. The



company's software powers more than 375 million websites, including for some well-known brands like Netflix, Starbucks and McDonald's, according to NGINX sources.

"We are now officially part of F5.

NGINX is becoming a business unit within F5, led by Gus Robertson. We will continue to focus on our existing open source projects and commercial products," the NGINX official statement stated.

Nearly all NGINX employees will join F5 to run the NGINX business from its headquarters in San Francisco, along with new colleagues from F5. NGINX currently has about 250 employees.

In his latest blog post, Gus Robertson, SVP and general manager, NGINX, wrote, "I'll be leading the new NGINX business unit within F5. I'll report directly to F5's CEO François Locoh-Donou and work closely with Kara Sprague, F5's executive VP and GM, application services, on F5 software solutions."

"We plan to accelerate NGINX Controller development. Now that we're one company, the F5 and NGINX engineering and product teams will work closely and collaboratively," Robertson added.

The companies are planning to integrate their product lines, along with ideas for new NGINX products. As shared earlier by spokespersons from both the companies, the acquisition may result in F5 security solutions adding protection to NGINX products, and NGINX load balancing software supporting F5's cloud-native solutions.

Through the course of this acquisition, F5 is looking to accelerate its 'software and multi-cloud transformation'. F5's CEO, François Locoh-Donou, said, "Together, F5 and NGINX could bridge a divide—between applications and infrastructure, and between the developer and operations." The Seattle based firm, F5, first announced its intention to acquire NGINX on March 11 this year.

## MongoDB to acquire Realm, a mobile database startup, for US\$ 39 million

Database company, MongoDB, has announced that it has entered into a definitive agreement to acquire Realm, the company behind the Realm mobile database and



synchronisation platform, for US\$ 39 million in cash, subject to certain adjustments.

The acquisition is expected to close in the second quarter of MongoDB's fiscal year-ending, on January 31,